

ADDITIONAL ACTIONS - These are always optional.

1. Complete 1 Contract



Return necessary **Goods and/or Camels**, receive the **reward** on the Contract Tile, place Tile face down on **drawer** on Player Board.

2. Take 3 Coins



Place **1 die** on Coin Bag, receive **3 Coins** from the general supply (regardless of the die value).

3. Re-roll 1 Die



Return **1 Camel** to the general supply, **re-roll 1 die**.

4. Adjust 1 Die Value +1/-1



Return **2 Camels** to the general supply, **adjust the value of 1 die** by 1 number up or down.

5. Take 1 Black Die



Return **3 Camels** to the general supply, **take 1 black die, roll it**, and place it on your Player Board. **Note:** Each player may only obtain **1 black die per turn**.

ROUND SEQUENCE – How is a round played?

BEGINNING OF A ROUND

1. Determine a new start player.

The start player is the player who last performed the “Travel” action in the previous round.



2. Collect any Small Town and Character bonuses.

All “!” bonuses are distributed. These are found on all Small Towns and on some Character Tiles.



3. Retrieve dice from the board.

All players return their dice to their Player Board.

All black dice are returned to their area on the game board.

4. Roll dice, place on Player Boards, collect any compensation.

All player roll their dice and place them on their Player Boards. On a **roll of less than 15**, the player takes either 1 Camel **or** 1 Coin for each pip below 15 he has rolled.

PLAYING A ROUND

1. The player performs 1 or more additional actions, if desired.

2. The player must perform 1 main action.

3. The player performs 1 or more additional actions, if desired.

It is then the next player's turn, in clockwise order.

A round ends when all players have used all of their dice.

END OF THE ROUND

1. All Contract Tiles remaining on the board are cleared.

2. 6 new Contract Tiles are placed on the board.



FINAL SCORING – How are points earned at the game's end?

After 5 rounds, the game ends. Final victory points are earned:

* for the 2 **Objective Cards**

* for every 10 **Coins** = 1 VP



* for **Trading Posts** in Beijing



* for every 2 **Goods** (not Camels) = 1 VP, only if the player has a Trading Post in Beijing



* for the player with the **most completed Contracts**: 7 VP



GAME SETUP: NORMAL GAME

1. Lay out game board, and supply of Good, Camels, and Coins.

2. **Small Town Bonus Tiles:**

Fixed distribution  –  (as printed on the game board).



3. **Large City Office Bonus Tiles and Cards:**

Random distribution.



4. **Form 5 stacks of Contracts (6 Tiles each), and distribute 1 stack to the board. The rest form the “special” stack.**



5. **Distribute dice to board per number of players:**



4 Players: All 5 black dice



3 Players: 4 black dice plus 1 non-player die for game balance, p. 15



2 Players: 3 black dice plus 3 non-player dice for game balance, p. 15.

6. **Determine start player.**



FOR EACH PLAYER:

1. **Take player materials (only 2 Figures):**

Dice and Trading Posts placed on Player Board, 1 Figure on “50” space of the scoring track, 1 Figure in Venezia.

2. **Take 1 Starting Contract Tile (with blue seal).**



3. **Take Camels and Coins:**

Each player takes 2 Camels

Start player: **7 Coins**

2nd player (clockwise): **8 Coins**

3rd player: **9 Coins**

4th player: **10 Coins.**



4. **Take Character Tile:**

Fixed distribution: Start player: **Raschid ad-Din Sinan**

2nd player: **Matteo Polo**

3rd player: **Berke Khan**

4th player: **Mercator ex Tabriz.**



5. **Take Objective Cards:**

Each player draws 2 Objective Cards from the deck.

6. **Take Overview Card, and begin the game!**



GAME SETUP: ADVANCED GAME

1. Lay out game board, and supply of Good, Camels, and Coins.
2. **Small Town Bonus Tiles:**

Random distribution.



3. **Large City Office Bonus Tiles and Cards:**

Random distribution.



4. **Form 5 stacks of Contracts (6 Tiles each), and distribute 1 stack to the board. The rest form the "special" stack.**



5. **Distribute dice to board per number of players:**



4 Players: All 5 black dice



3 Players: 4 black dice plus 1 non-player die for game balance, p. 15



2 Players: 3 black dice plus 3 non-player dice for game balance, p. 15.

6. **Determine start player.**



FOR EACH PLAYER:

1. **Take player materials (only 2 Figures):**

Dice and Trading Posts placed on Player Board, 1 Figure on "50" space of the scoring track, 1 Figure in Venezia.

2. **Take 1 Starting Contract Tile (with blue seal).**



3. **Take Camels and Coins:**

Each player takes 2 Camels

Start player: **7 Coins**

2nd player (clockwise): **8 Coins**

3rd player: **9 Coins**

4th player: **10 Coins.**



4. **Take Character Tile:**



4 Players: Deal 5 Character Tiles face up to the table.



3 Players: Deal 4 Character Tiles face up to the table.



2 Players: Deal 3 Character Tiles face up to the table.



Starting with the player last in turn order, and continuing counter-clockwise, each player selects a Character Tile and places it in front of him.

5. **Take Objective Cards:**

Each player draws 4 Objective Cards, keeps 2, discards the other 2.



6. **Take Overview Card, and begin the game!**